TRANSPORTATION

Rivian CEO RJ Scaringe’s voting control slips following divorce settlement

Sean O'Kane — 7:52 AM PDT · July 14, 2025

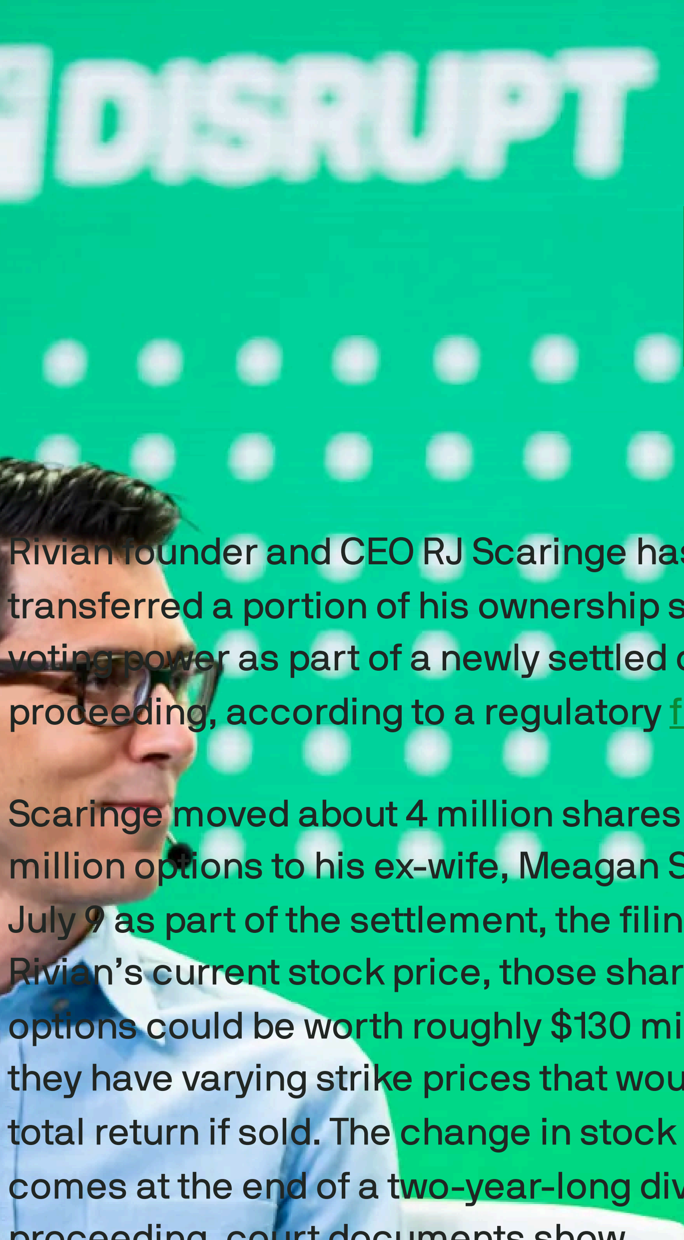


IMAGE CREDITS: HAJE KAMPS / TECHCRUNCH

Rivian founder and CEO RJ Scaringe has transferred a portion of his ownership stake and voting power as part of a newly settled divorce proceeding, according to a regulatory filing.

Scaringe moved about 4 million shares and 6 million options to his ex-wife, Meagan Scaringe, on July 9 as part of the settlement, the filing shows. At Rivian's current stock price, those shares and options could be worth roughly $130 million, though they have varying strike prices that would affect the total return if sold. The change in stock ownership comes at the end of a two-year-long divorce proceeding, court documents show.

Scaringe owned more than 15 million shares of Class A stock and nearly 8 million Class B shares when the company submitted its annual proxy report April 29. As a result of the transfer, Scaringe's voting power has slipped from 7.6% earlier this year to around 4%, the lowest since Rivian's 2021 IPO.

The shift in stock ownership doesn't have an impact on Rivian's business or operations, according to the company.

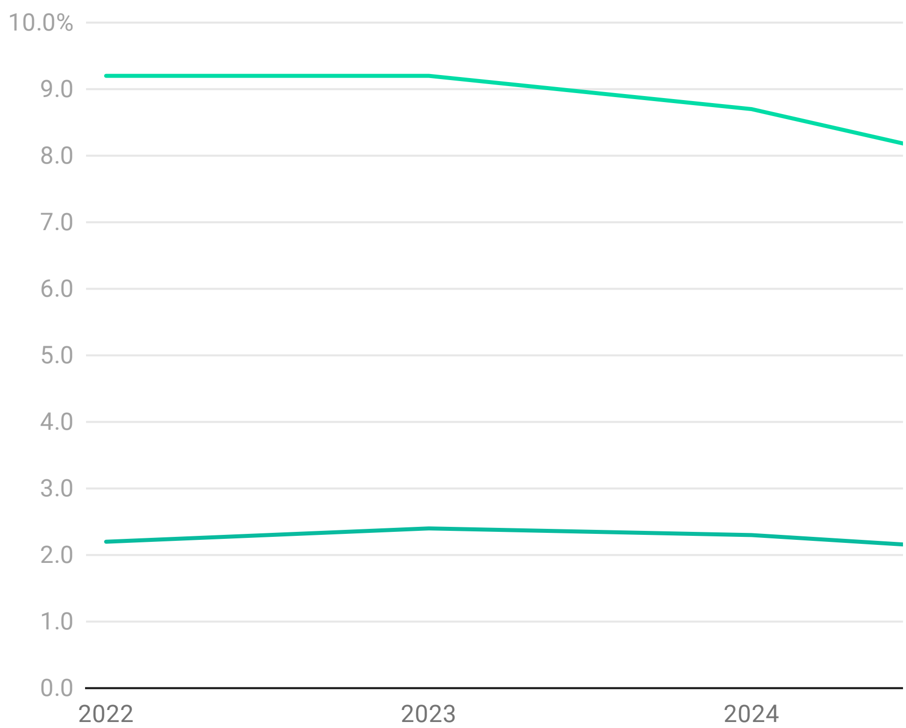
In an official statement emailed to TechCrunch, a spokesperson said "RJ and Meagan finalized their divorce. They will continue to prioritize co-parenting their children."

Most Popular

- Key sections of the US Constitution deleted from government's website
- Three weeks after acquiring Windsurf, Cognition offers staff the exit door
- Roku launches Howdy, a $2.99 ad-free streaming service
- Spotify raises subscription prices
- The uproar over Vogue's AI-generated ad isn't just about fashion

The settlement comes at a pivotal time for Rivian. Rivian has redesigned its R1S SUV and R1T truck in a bid to lower manufacturing costs, while improving performance of its flagship vehicles. However, the company is banking on the next addition to its lineup — the highly anticipated R2 SUV that has a $45,000 base price — to grow sales. That vehicle won't go on sale until the first half of 2026.

Rivian CEO's voting power and ownership post-IPO



Source: SEC • Get the data • Created with Datawrapper

The ownership structure of Rivian has shifted since its IPO in 2021. At that time, Amazon and Ford were among the largest stakeholders. Today, Ford is essentially out and Volkswagen Group has emerged as a major player.

In late 2024, Rivian entered into a joint venture valued at $5.8 billion with Volkswagen focused on software and electrical architecture. Rivian has provided technology and employees to the joint venture, while Volkswagen has largely contributed money in the form of share purchases and convertible debt.

As a result, the German automotive giant now owns 12.3% of Rivian, according to a recent filing. That puts it slightly behind Amazon, which owned 14.2% of Rivian as of the April 2025 proxy filing. That's enough to give Amazon the most voting power of any single shareholder: 13.3%. (Ford and T. Rowe Price also used to be major shareholders after the IPO, but have since sold down their stakes.)

Scaringe's ownership stake in Rivian was 2% prior to the divorce settlement, according to the proxy filing. But he had a 7.6% share of the voting power, thanks in part to the Class B stock, which comes with 10 votes per share. (Rivian's Class A stock only comes with 1 vote per share.) The transfer of shares and options in the settlement cuts his voting power to around 4%.

Unlike many high-profile tech founders, Scaringe never had a tremendous amount of voting power post-IPO. The most he wielded was 9.2% in 2022. That figure remained unchanged in 2023, fell to

8.7% in 2024, and again to 7.6% in 2025 following the Volkswagen investment.

The Class B stock included in the settlement was automatically converted into Class A stock, meaning Scaringe's ex-wife will not likely have much voting power relative to other shareholders if she maintains the holding. A lawyer representing her did not respond to a request for comment sent over the weekend.

The CEO and founder still controls a mix of around 50 million shares, options, and Restricted Stock Units, or RSUs. As those fully vest, his ownership stake and voting power could go back up.

Scaringe founded Rivian in 2009, and he was married in 2014. He took Rivian public in 2021.

Records obtained from Orange County Superior Court show that he filed for divorce in October 2023, with his ex-wife agreeing to separate in another filing one month later.

Topics: Rivian RJ Scaringe Transportation

Sean O'Kane
Sr. Reporter, Transportation

Sean O'Kane is a reporter who has spent a decade covering the rapidly-evolving business and technology o...

View Bio

KEEP READING

Space Florida’s incredible shrinking Rivian stake

The state’s economic development agency thought it owned 3% of EV behemoth Rivian. It was very, very wrong.

Mark Harris

9:30 AM PST · December 14, 2021

IMAGE CREDITS: KIRSTEN KOROSEC

It would have been a legendary payoff for any investor, let alone a public agency: swapping an undrivable car for a multibillion-dollar stake in a hot new EV startup.

Until last year, Space Florida, the state's economic development agency for aerospace, believed that it owned 3% of Rivian as a result of a canny lease-back agreement made a decade earlier. Following Rivian's blockbuster IPO in November, that stake would have been worth nearly $3 billion based on Rivian's current market capitalization — a more than 1,000-fold return on Space Florida's investment. That investment, which totaled nearly $2 million, included buying prototypes from Rivian in exchange for warrants in the company as well as the cost of buying the stock.

Instead — and through a mechanism that neither the agency nor Rivian can explain — Space Florida has ended up holding just 60,000 shares in the company, worth less than $7 million, public records from the agency show.

So why did a commercial space booster get involved with an EV pickup maker in the first place, and how did its supposed ownership evaporate?

Space Florida began working with Rivian before it was called Rivian — and even before it was making electric vehicles. In 2009, RJ Scaringe founded Mainstream Motors as a spin-out from his father's R&D firm in Rockledge, Florida. His original plan was to design an ultra-efficient gas-powered coupe capable of 60 miles per gallon and bring it into production in Florida using lightweight materials and modular manufacturing, all by the end of 2013.

The Florida Energy and Climate Commission committed $2 million in seed money, enough for Scaringe to hire a small team to design a prototype. This is separate from Rivian's deal with Space Florida. According to a Bloomberg report, the team then worked around the clock to produce plans for the vehicle, apart from its engine. When the plans were ready, they shipped them to a contract manufacturer in Detroit, along with a Mini Cooper for its powerplant.

Scaringe then pulled off what must have seemed to be a stroke of genius. In June 2010, with the company's first prototype still just a collection of custom and scavenged parts in Detroit, Scaringe sold it to Space Florida for $500,000.

"Originally, there was a potential that it would bring an automobile manufacturing plant to Florida," Dale Ketcham, VP of Space Florida, told TechCrunch in a recent interview. "But it was more the possible applications off-planet, whether on the moon or Mars, that piqued our interest."

When the first prototype, nicknamed "The Blue Thing," arrived in Florida in October 2010, Space Florida immediately leased it back to Scaringe for $100 a year. The car was not ready to drive on public roads, let alone move into production, according to Bloomberg. But the company could use it for testing and demonstrations, including a (never-consummated) plan to speed-test it at NASA's Shuttle Landing Facility in the Kennedy Space Center, records obtained through a Freedom of Information Act request show. After the 10-year lease was up, Scaringe could repurchase the vehicle from Space Florida for a final $100.

But as an "additional consideration," according to Space Florida documents, the startup would also issue to Space Florida a warrant to acquire 100 shares of its common stock, redeemable any time in the next decade, for $1,000 per share.

"It's one of the little things we'd done in the past with other organizations," Ketcham recalled. "It gave us a little piece of the pie and it gave them some cash." Space Florida also assisted the small company with business advice.

Scaringe changed Mainstream Motors' name to Avera. In March 2011, he changed it again — to Rivian — and persuaded Space Florida to repeat the deal. The agency would buy three more vehicles for $1 million, and once more lease them back to Rivian for $100 a year. This time, Rivian issued Space Florida a warrant for a further 200 shares, at $1,843 each. Which means if Space Florida wanted to redeem those shares it would cost them $368,600.

It was a dark time for Rivian. Scaringe was scrambling for investors and down to a skeleton crew of employees. It took Rivian until June 2014 to complete the three promised vehicles, and months more to start the lease. Soon afterward, and following a big investment from Saudi Arabia, Scaringe relocated Rivian to Michigan, bought a factory in Illinois and put Florida in his rearview mirror.

But he left a little bit of his company behind. Space Florida recorded the Rivian warrant agreements in its financial statement for the year 2013. The first warrant for 100 shares, it noted, "is estimated to equal a 1% ownership interest" in the company. The second, for 200, "is equal to a 2% ownership interest." Space Florida believed its 300 shares represented a full 3% of the

RIVIAN CEO RJ SCARINGE SPEAKS IN NOVEMBER 2018 BEFORE UNVEILING THE COMPANY'S TWO FIRST ELECTRIC VEHICLES AT AN EVENT AT THE GRIFFITH OBSERVATORY IN LOS ANGELES.

IMAGE CREDITS : GETTY/PHILLIP FARAONE

In 2018, Scaringe told TechCrunch: "We've got a good relationship with Space Florida. They hoped we would be able to manufacture there but as the company began to grow, the lack of automotive infrastructure became a problem. They do have a significant number of warrants, and I would imagine they're quite pleased with the progress of the company given that those warrants are becoming quite valuable."

But how valuable exactly? Between 2013 and 2020, Space Florida accounted for those 300 warrants at their cost price of just under $1.5 million. In the meantime, Rivian's valuation soared from the $10 million that the 2010 Space Florida transaction implied into the billions, and its stock split multiple times. (This means that even a handful of shares acquired in Rivian's early days as a private company could have turned into many thousands as the company grew and eventually went public).

All the while, Space Florida assumed that it still owned 3% of Rivian, according to public financial statements filed as late as October 2020.

The warrants were finally executed in late 2020. The latest financial statement, issued by Space Florida in October, now shows the agency holding just 60,000 Rivian shares, worth less than $7 million. That is about 500 times less than a 3% stake would represent and less than half of what Space Florida would have earned if it had simply invested in the Nasdaq instead of Rivian a decade ago.

"Something does feel a little weird here," said Scott Orn, COO at Kruze Consulting, an accounting firm that specializes in funded early-stage companies. He notes that an early ownership interest can be diluted as bigger investors come on board, or be reduced by other strategies, such as recapitalizing the company. "But you're going to go from, say, 10% ownership to 1% ownership," he says. "You can't wash them out completely."

Rivian would not comment on Space Florida's warrant agreements or ownership stake, citing shareholder confidentiality. Space Florida did not dispute the figures in its financial statements but declined to comment on the value of its investment "pending board review of policy for these issues."

Ketcham predicted that "it will still prove to have been a very nice investment for the state."

Despite the large and somewhat mysterious discrepancy, Space Florida has no plans to pursue Rivian through the courts. "Our relationship with Rivian has been and remains excellent," Ketcham said. "They did what they needed to do. And we want them to succeed as much as anything."

But the disappearances don't end there: Neither organization could tell TechCrunch what happened to the four original prototype Rivian vehicles that nearly rewrote investing history.

Topics: Amazon electric vehicles florida R1T Rivian Transportation

Mark Harris

View Bio

KEEP READING

Rivian founder RJ Scaringe snaps up $1M worth of EV maker's stock

Kirsten Korosec 3:25 PM PDT · May 16, 2022

IMAGE CREDITS: KIRSTEN KOROSEC

Rivian founder and CEO RJ Scaringe bought 41,000 shares of company stock worth about $1 million, a securities filing posted Monday afternoon shows.

The latest proxy filing, which pre-dated this purchase, shows Scaringe owns 11.99 million shares of class A stock, or about 1.3%, and 7.82 million class B common stock. He also holds 4.3 million indirect shares via a trust and 4,595 indirect shares through an LLC.

The purchase comes as Rivian shares fell Monday following news of a legal dispute with a seat supplier that puts its Amazon electric van program at risk and Ford's disclosure that it has sold another 7 million of its holdings in the company.

A Rivian spokesperson declined to comment on why Scaringe was buying the stock now.

Rivian debuted as a publicly traded company in November with an opening share price of $106.75, a price that made it one of the largest IPOs in U.S. history and put its market cap above GM and Ford. (At the time, GM's market cap was $86.31 billion; Ford's was $78.2 billion.)

The company's share price reached as high as $179.47 a week later. But a combination of general volatility in the market and material disclosures by Rivian have caused its share price to fall more than 75% since its public market opener.

Ford, which held a 12% stake, or about 102 million shares, of Rivian, sold 8 million shares of the company earlier this month. That initial sale, prompted Rivian shares to fall more than 17%. On May 13, Ford sold another 7 million shares, pushing its total stake below 10%.

Latest in Transportation

See More

TRANSPORTATION

Federal regulators give Zoox an exemption for its custom-built robotaxis

Kirsten Korosec

- 15 hours ago

TRANSPORTATION

Jeh Aerospace nets $11M to scale the commercial aircraft supply chain in India

Jagmeet Singh - 2 days ago

TRANSPORTATION

Foxconn sells former GM factory to mystery buyer after failing to make EVs

Sean O'Kane - 3 days ago

That "below 10%" threshold means that Ford no longer has to file a Form D with the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission. According to the SEC's rules, "insiders" that own 10% or more shares have to report most of their transactions involving the company's equity securities to the SEC within two business days on Forms 3, 4 or 5.

As a beneficial owner, Ford will still have to file a Schedule 13D report, which is required within 10 days of transaction, until its stake falls below 5%.

The article has been updated to clarify that Scaringe's shares purchase came as shares fell Monday; the share price was not at a new low.

Topics: electric vehicles EV Ford Rivian RJ Scaringe Transportation transportation

Kirsten Korosec

Transportation Editor

Kirsten Korosec is a reporter and editor who has covered the future of transportation from EVs and autonomous...

View Bio